CASH TO COMPANY

Item Bank

"Money, pricing, and profit"

Per-unit quiz / test items · 4 units · ETS-quality alignment to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS

Grade 5 — Cash to Company Item Bank

Year theme: *Money, pricing, and profit.* This bank covers all four Grade 5 units (Where do business ideas come from? · The math of one sale · Persuasion in the wild · Run the market). Items use decimals + fractions for margin (CCSS 5.NBT.B.7, 5.NF.B.6). Distractors target the Grade 5 Common Misconceptions table. No family-money probes; "for a hypothetical" framing throughout. Cash's Grade 5 voice: "*Revenue is loud. What's left is what you keep.*"

Unit 1: Where do business ideas come from?

MC1. "For a hypothetical 5th-grader, the strongest source of a business idea is..."

A. A famous person on TV · B. A skill they have, a hobby they do, AND a need they actually see · C. Whatever sells fastest · D. Whatever costs least

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CCSS-ELA SL.5.4 — Report on a topic in an organized manner.* · **Strand outcome (BAVC, 5):** *I can explain in writing how a real business creates value — what they make/do, who pays, and why someone is willing to pay.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Ideas come from copying*" — corrects.

MC2. "You have 8 ideas in your brainstorm. The next move is..."

A. Pick the one that excites you most · B. Cluster similar ideas, then vote on the cluster that fits a real customer · C. Pick the one your friend likes · D. Pick the one with the prettiest name

Answer: B · **Standard:** *NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-1 — Define a simple design problem reflecting a need or a want.* · **Strand outcome (PSIG, 5):** *I can take three problem prompts and run each through brainstorm → cluster → vote, ending with one chosen idea with reasons.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*My favorite is the right answer*" — A, C, D bait this.

MC3. "For a hypothetical idea, the question 'Why would someone PAY for this?' answers..."

A. The customer's willingness to pay · B. Your enthusiasm · C. Your friend's opinion · D. Your hobby

Answer: A · **Standard:** *C3 D2.Eco.7.3-5 — Explain how profits influence sellers in markets.* · **Strand outcome (BAVC, 5):** *I can explain in writing how a real business creates value — what they make/do, who pays, and why someone is willing to pay.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*If I love it, customers love it*" — corrects.

SA1. "For your idea, write a 3-sentence value explanation: (a) what you make/do, (b) who pays, (c) why they're willing to pay."

Model answer: "*I make hand-painted phone grips. Middle-schoolers buy them. They pay $5 because the standard ones at the store cost $8 and aren't customizable.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** All three sentences specific AND the WHY-PAY names a real comparison. - **2:** Three sentences but one vague. - **1:** Missing one sentence.

SA2. "Take your top idea. Write 2 reasons it might fail. Be specific."

Model answer: "*1. Middle-schoolers might prefer pre-made designs over custom (saving 30 min of waiting). 2. Materials cost $3, leaving $2 profit; if I miscount and use too much paint, I lose money on each grip.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Two specific failure modes, each with a real-world reason. - **2:** One specific. - **1:** Vague ("might not work").

Performance Task: Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web → Two Ranked Ideas (60 min over 2 sessions).

Child completes a SHN web with at least 4 entries per column, picks two ranked ideas, and writes one paragraph per idea defending the rank with 2 reasons. **Rubric:** Reflection Writing Rubric (Grade 5): (1) web complete to 4+, (2) two ideas ranked, (3) each defense names a reason rooted in customer or skill fit. **Strand outcome:** BAVC + PSIG.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*For your top idea, name three customers who are NOT your target. Why?*" Anchors the segmentation move; previews Grade 7 personas.

Unit 2: The math of one sale

MC1. "For a hypothetical lemonade cup: cost $0.30, target margin 40%. What's the price?"

A. $0.42 · B. $0.50 · C. $0.43 · D. $0.70

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CCSS-Math 5.NF.B.6 — Solve real-world problems involving multiplication of fractions and mixed numbers.* · **Strand outcome (MFL, 5):** *I can calculate unit cost, set a price using a target margin (e.g., 40%), and predict total profit at multiple sales volumes.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Margin is just 'add a little'*" — Price = Cost / (1 - margin) = $0.30 / 0.60 = $0.50; A is just cost+40% which is wrong.

MC2. "Your cost per cup is $0.30. You sell at $0.20. You sell 100 cups. What's your profit?"

A. $20 · B. $10 · C. -$10 · D. $0.20

Answer: C · **Standard:** *CCSS-Math 5.NBT.B.7 — Add, subtract, multiply, and divide decimals.* · **Strand outcome (MFL, 5):** *I can calculate unit cost, set a price using a target margin, and predict total profit at multiple sales volumes.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*If I sell more, I'll always make more money*" — corrects: negative contribution margin × volume = bigger loss.

MC3. "For a hypothetical product, the math says minimum price is $1. The customer's willingness to pay is $3. The right price is..."

A. $1, the lowest · B. $3, the maximum · C. Somewhere between $1 and $3 based on competition and value · D. $5, to look fancy

Answer: C · **Standard:** *C3 D2.Eco.7.3-5 — Explain how profits influence sellers in markets.* · **Strand outcome (CBM, 5):** *I can write a 30-second "elevator pitch" for my business idea that names the customer, the problem, and the price.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*I should pick the highest price the math allows*" — corrects.

SA1. "Cost = $0.40 per cup. Target margin = 50%. Show pricing math. Then predict profit at 50 cups, 100 cups, 200 cups sold."

Model answer: "*Price = $0.40 / (1 - 0.5) = $0.80. Profit per cup = $0.80 - $0.40 = $0.40. 50 cups: $20. 100 cups: $40. 200 cups: $80.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Pricing math correct ($0.80) AND all three profit numbers. - **2:** Price correct, one volume calc wrong. - **1:** Price wrong.

SA2. "Write a 30-second elevator pitch for your business idea. Name the customer, the problem they have, and the price."

Model answer: "*Hi, I'm Maya. I make custom hand-painted phone grips for middle-schoolers who hate the same boring patterns at the store. Each grip is one-of-a-kind, takes 5 minutes, and costs $5 — three dollars less than the plain ones at the mall. Want one?*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Names customer + problem + price + a comparison or specific number; under 60 seconds when read. - **2:** Three of four elements. - **1:** Vague.

Performance Task: Pricing Decision (60 min, individual).

Child picks a chosen idea, computes cost and price at a 40% target margin, and predicts profit at three volumes (low / middle / high). Writes a 1-sentence justification for the chosen price beyond the math. **Rubric:** Budget Project Rubric (Grade 5): (1) cost computed correctly, (2) price math correct, (3) three-volume profit table correct, (4) justification names customer reason. **Strand outcome:** MFL + CBM.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*At what sales volume does your business break even (profit = $0) if your fixed costs are $20 per week?*" Targets break-even seed; previews Grade 8.

Unit 3: Persuasion in the wild

MC1. (Two ads shown: Ad A says "9 out of 10 dentists recommend Toothy Whitener!"; Ad B says "Don't be the only kid in your friend group with yellow teeth.") Cash asks: What technique does Ad A use?

A. Bandwagon · B. Scarcity · C. Authority · D. Fear

Answer: C · **Standard:** *CCSS-ELA SL.5.4 — Report on a topic in an organized manner.* · **Strand outcome (ESL, 5):** *I can read a kid-aimed ad and identify at least 2 persuasive techniques (scarcity, bandwagon, authority) with examples.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Ads are just designed to inform*" — corrects.

MC2. "What technique does Ad B use?"

A. Authority · B. Bandwagon (everyone else has it) · C. Scarcity · D. Honesty

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CCSS-ELA SL.5.4.* · **Strand outcome (ESL, 5):** *I can read a kid-aimed ad and identify at least 2 persuasive techniques.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Ads are just designed to inform*" — corrects.

MC3. "What does it mean for an ad to make 'an honest claim'?"

A. The claim is fancy · B. The claim is specific, true, and the customer can verify it · C. The claim is loud · D. The claim makes you laugh

Answer: B · **Standard:** *Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-2.* · **Strand outcome (ESL, 5):** *I can read a kid-aimed ad and identify at least 2 persuasive techniques.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Honesty is just for grown-ups*" — corrects.

SA1. "Look at two real ads (provided). Label at least 5 persuasive techniques across them. For each, write the actual ad text that uses the technique."

Model answer: "*Ad 1: 'Limited time offer!' = scarcity. 'Recommended by Dr. Tooth' = authority. 'Be the cool kid' = bandwagon. Ad 2: 'You can't afford NOT to' = fear. 'Only 3 left' = scarcity again.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** 5+ techniques correctly labeled with quoted ad text. - **2:** 3-4 techniques. - **1:** 2 or fewer.

SA2. "For an ad you reviewed, write one column of 'fact' (verifiable) and one column of 'opinion' (feeling). Give 2 in each column."

Model answer: "*Facts: '$3.99 a tube' (price is checkable); 'whitens in 7 days' (testable). Opinions: 'the freshest taste' (no measurement); 'makes you confident' (a feeling, not a claim).*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** 2 facts + 2 opinions all correctly classified. - **2:** 3 of 4 correct. - **1:** 2 or fewer correct.

Performance Task: Two-Ad Analysis (60 min, individual).

Child analyzes two real kid-aimed ads (teacher-supplied), labels at least 5 persuasive techniques, and creates a 2-column "fact vs. opinion" table with at least 4 entries. **Rubric:** Customer Research Rubric (Grade 5): (1) 5+ techniques labeled, (2) fact/opinion table populated, (3) one-paragraph reflection on which technique would shift their behavior most. **Strand outcome:** ESL + CBM.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*Rewrite the most manipulative claim in one of these ads as an HONEST claim that would still make a real customer interested.*" Targets the Cash voice's "honest claims build customers who come back."

Unit 4: Run the market

MC1. "After your Classroom Market Day, you sold 18 of 40 lemonades. The post-market debrief asks: 'What worked / what flopped / what I'd change.' Which is a 'what flopped' answer (not a complaint)?"

A. The teacher made me run it · B. My customers were grumpy · C. I priced at $1 but most kids only had 50¢; I lost half my customers at the price · D. It wasn't fair

Answer: C · **Standard:** *CCSS-ELA SL.5.4.* · **Strand outcome (LRCI, 5):** *I can run a "post-market debrief" answering "what worked / what flopped / what I'd change" with at least 2 specific items each.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*A flop is bad luck*" — corrects with a specific cause.

MC2. "Your inventory tracker shows: started with 40 cups, sold 18, ended with 19 cups. Where's the discrepancy?"

A. There is no discrepancy · B. 3 cups are missing or unaccounted · C. You sold 22 not 18 · D. The tracker is broken

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CCSS-Math 5.NBT.B.7.* · **Strand outcome (OSO, 5):** *I can use a simple inventory tracker (start, sold, ending, restock) for a one-day classroom market and explain a discrepancy.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Inventory math always balances*" — 40 - 18 = 22, but ending = 19, so 3 are unaccounted.

MC3. "After the market, the post-debrief should focus on..."

A. Who was at fault · B. What specifically I'd change next time and why · C. How unfair the day was · D. Whose feelings got hurt

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CASEL Responsible Decision-Making.* · **Strand outcome (LRCI, 5):** *I can run a "post-market debrief" answering "what worked / what flopped / what I'd change."* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Reflection is blame*" — corrects.

SA1. "Write your post-market debrief: 2 specific items each for what worked, what flopped, what I'd change."

Model answer: "*WORKED: (a) Putting prices in big numbers — every customer read them right. (b) Having change ready in advance — no awkward waits. FLOPPED: (a) $1 was too high; lost ~10 customers at price. (b) Ran out of cups by 2pm — turned away 5 customers. CHANGE: (a) Lower price to $0.50 OR offer half-cup at half-price. (b) Bring 60 cups instead of 40.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** 6 items total, each specific. - **2:** 5 items. - **1:** 4 or fewer, OR vague.

SA2. "Your inventory tracker shows 3 cups unaccounted. What are 3 plausible explanations? Which would you investigate first?"

Model answer: "*1. Miscounted at start. 2. Spilled and thrown away. 3. Free taste-tests not logged. I'd check #3 first because it's the easiest to verify with my partner.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Three real explanations + an investigative priority with reasoning. - **2:** Three explanations, no priority. - **1:** Fewer than 3.

Performance Task: Classroom Market Day + Debrief (full school day).

Child runs a 2-hour market stall with their priced product (Unit 2 pricing), tracks inventory in real time, and on day 2 writes a 1-page post-market debrief. **Rubric:** Reflection Writing Rubric (Grade 5): (1) inventory math reconciles or discrepancy is named, (2) debrief has 2 items each in what worked / flopped / change, (3) at least one change names a specific number ("lower price to $0.50") not a vibe ("be more friendly"). **Strand outcome:** LRCI + OSO + MFL.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*You'd lower price to $0.50. Run the math: at $0.50, what's your new contribution margin? At what volume do you match the profit you got at $1?*" Targets the cost-volume-profit interplay; previews Grade 7 contribution-margin work.

Total this grade: 12 MC + 8 SA + 4 Performance Tasks + 4 Extensions = 28 items.